

▼ FRENCH UNIFORM

Date Up to 1915

Origin France

Material Wool, leather, brass

The French army was one of the last to give up its brightly coloured field uniform – red breeches and a long-tailed blue coat – in favour of drab colours. Conversely, it was the first to adopt a steel helmet in place of the cloth *képi*.



Heavy leather belt-and-braces and ammunition pouches

Uniform made from "horizon blue" cloth

Triple-edged Lebel bayonet, nicknamed "Rosalie"

Red woollen breeches

French army boots

▼ RUSSIAN UNIFORM

Date 1914

Origin Russia

Material Wool, leather, sheepskin

Russia adopted light brown for its field uniform in 1907. Cossack units continued to wear the traditional sheepskin *Papakha* hat, while artillerymen were issued a short sword instead of a bayonet.



Sheepskin Papakha hat

▼ AMERICAN UNIFORM

Date 1917

Origin US

Material Wool

The US Army introduced olive uniforms in 1902, although some troops had worn the colour in the Spanish-American War of 1898. The hat was a hangover from earlier times, but when US forces appeared in Europe in 1917, they had copies of the British steel helmet.



Ammunition pouch

► AMERICAN EQUIPMENT

Date 1917

Origin US

Material Cotton, brass

American soldiers were issued webbing comprising a belt and braces, which held ammunition pouches and a water-bottle holder, plus a bayonet frog.

Water-bottle holder